SATYAM SUNDARAM, 27
Purnia, Bihar



HOUSE OF BAMBOO

From modest beginnings in rural Bihar, an eco-enterprise now crafts 300 bamboo products sold across 25 states

By AMITABH SRIVASTAVA

IF **bamboo symbolises resilience**, so does 27-year-old Satyam Sundaram. From modest beginnings in Purnia, Bihar, he now runs a thriving eco-enterprise that supplies 300 handcrafted bamboo products across 25 states.

Satyam grew up in a household where sustenance came from his father's humble vocation: cooking in the Bihar Police mess. Satyam tried hard for a government post, but fell short. An MBA in Kolkata became his turning point. Internships with major brands taught him persuasion, market strategy and the fundamentals of selling—skills that would define his career. Still, starting something of his own was easier said than done.

In the post-COVID wave of "return to nature" thinking, Satyam saw bamboo as an untapped alternative to plastic. However, securing finance was a battle. After months of running between offices, he finally obtained a Rs 7.91 lakh loan in February 2022 under the Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP). Yet before factories and franchises, he spent long days on Purnia's streets, selling bamboo bottles. "Those first sales taught me patience," he recalls. "If you believe in your product, you stand there until someone else believes too."

Today, the transformation is striking. Step inside the headquarters of Manipuri Bamboo Architecture in Maranga, on Purnia's edge, and the air carries a faint, woody

FACT SHEET

Name of company
Manipuri Bamboo Architecture

What they do: **Make and supply hancrafted bamboo products**

Founded in: **2022**

Annual turnover
Rs 40 lakh

Photograph by **RANJAN RAHI**